Mapping the questions buyers ask AI *before they ever book a call.*

A content plan for a growth agency that serves owner-operated e-commerce stores. It maps the prompts a skeptical store owner runs through ChatGPT and Perplexity, sorts them by decision stage, and assigns each one an answer asset, a format, and a source of proof.

WHAT THIS SAMPLE DEMONSTRATES

- Turning an ICP and a sales funnel into a list of real buyer prompts
- Sorting prompts by decision stage, not by keyword volume
- Matching each prompt to proof the client already owns
- Flagging the gaps where new evidence has to be created first
- A repeatable method for checking who answer engines cite today

WRITTEN FOR BUYER PROMPTS LIKE

“what should an e-commerce growth audit include” · “is my Meta ROAS real” · “how do I improve ROAS without raising budget”

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What is a prompt-space map?

SHORT ANSWER

A prompt-space map is a list of the questions a target buyer asks AI assistants on the way to a purchase, sorted by decision stage. Each prompt is matched to the page that should answer it and the proof that makes that page worth citing. It replaces a keyword list as the starting point for content in AI search.

Who is the buyer?

An owner-operator running an established online store, typically **$30K to $150K a month** in revenue with an average order of **$500 or more**, selling functional parts rather than decor or basics. They have been burned by agencies, distrust screenshots, and increasingly check a decision with an AI assistant before booking a call.

That last habit is why the map matters. If the assistant answers their question with a competitor's page, the call never happens.

How the map is built

1. **Start from the sales path, not a keyword tool.** The agency's funnel already follows how this buyer decides: diagnose the problem, qualify the fit, see proof, then decide. The prompts are sorted into those four stages.
2. **Write prompts the way the buyer talks.** First person, specific, a little skeptical. “Is my Meta ROAS real?” not “ROAS accuracy”.
3. **Match each prompt to proof already on hand.** Answer engines cite pages with specific, checkable evidence. Prompts with existing case-study data get built first.
4. **Flag the gaps.** Where no proof exists yet, the plan names what evidence has to be created before the page is worth publishing.

The map: 16 prompts, four stages

STAGE = proof on hand, build now. STAGE = gap, create evidence first.

STAGE	BUYER PROMPT	ANSWER ASSET	FORMAT	PROOF ON HAND
DIAGNOSE	**Why is my store getting traffic but not sales?**	Traffic problem or system problem? A diagnostic explainer	Article + FAQ	CRO tests: three different constraints on one store
DIAGNOSE	**Why do shoppers add to cart and then leave?**	What happens after Add to Cart	Test write-up	Cart redirect: ≈76% more revenue per visitor
DIAGNOSE	**Are my product pages losing mobile buyers?**	Mobile-first product pages, explained	Article + table	Mobile rebuild: 2.2% → 4.1% conversion
DIAGNOSE	**Is my Meta ROAS real?**	What Meta ROAS actually proves (Sample 04)	Reference page	Six-month account: verified vs not shown
QUALIFY	**Do I need a marketing agency or a better system?**	Vendor vs owner: renting results or owning a system	Opinion + checklist	Point of view only. Needs a client story
QUALIFY	**What should an e-commerce growth audit include?**	Anatomy of a growth audit: messaging, acquisition, follow-up	Guide + HowTo	Audit structure exists. Needs a sample deliverable
QUALIFY	**Is a paid audit better than a free one?**	Why a diagnosis is worth paying for	Article + FAQ	Point of view only
QUALIFY	**Is my store too small for a growth agency?**	Who this is for, and who it is not for	Qualifier page	ICP criteria already written
PROVE	**Does Advantage+ Shopping work for catalog stores?**	One account, three campaign jobs	Case study + table	9.89x reported, 84.5% of sales from 74.3% of spend
PROVE	**Do retargeting ads work for high-ticket parts?**	Retargeting as a follow-up layer	Case study	6.20x reported, highest average order value
PROVE	**How do I improve ROAS without raising budget?**	Same event, less spend (Sample 02)	Case study	17.2x → about 35.9x on 2.6% less spend
PROVE	**Does social proof increase conversion?**	Video, ratings, or both? A four-way test	Test write-up	4.0% → 5.1% with both stacked
DECIDE	**What should I ask a growth agency before hiring?**	Twelve questions that expose cherry-picked results	Checklist + FAQ	Draws on the measurement rules in Samples 01 and 04
DECIDE	**What does a 90-day growth roadmap look like?**	The 13-week build, week by week	Timeline + HowTo	Process already defined

DECIDE	**How long until a new marketing system shows results?**	What changes in weeks 1–13, and what doesn't	Article + FAQ	Needs dated client milestones
DECIDE	**How do I compare two agency proposals?**	A side-by-side scoring sheet	Template + table	No proof needed. Utility asset

> READ 11 of 16 prompts can be answered now with evidence the agency already owns. Five need a client story, a sample deliverable, or dated milestones first.

Build order

WAVE	WHAT SHIPS	WHY FIRST
Wave 1	The four Prove pages and “Is my Meta ROAS real?”	Original, specific data is what answer engines cite. These pages have it today.
Wave 2	Remaining Diagnose pages and the Decide checklist and roadmap	They link down to the Wave 1 proof, which strengthens both.
Wave 3	The five gap pages	Ship once the missing client story, sample audit, or milestones exist.

How to check who AI assistants cite today

Run every prompt in ChatGPT, Perplexity, Google's AI Overviews, and Gemini before writing, then again monthly. Log the result in the same sheet so changes are visible over time.

PROMPT	ENGINE	BRAND MENTIONED?	SOURCES CITED	WHAT THE ANSWER GETS WRONG OR LEAVES OUT	DATE
Is my Meta ROAS real?	Perplexity	—	—	—	—
Is my Meta ROAS real?	ChatGPT	—	—	—	—
What should a growth audit include?	AI Overviews	—	—	—	—

The last column is the brief. Whatever the current answer gets wrong or leaves out is what the new page should say plainly, near the top.

Rules every page in the plan follows

- Open with a direct answer of 40 to 60 words that stands alone.

- Use the buyer's question as the heading, word for word where possible.
- Put every result next to its source and what it does not prove.
- Use tables for comparisons and numbered lists for processes.
- Add Article, FAQPage, or HowTo schema, plus Person schema for the author.
- Keep the agency's name, offer, and proof figures identical on every page, profile, and directory listing.

Writing sample by Justin Mitchiner. Built from an anonymized agency's funnel strategy and published case studies. The prompts are written from the buyer profile, not pulled from a prompt-volume tool. The citation log is a template. No AI-visibility results are shown or claimed. Figures in the proof column are platform-reported and carry the caveats in Samples 01, 02, and 04.